

Sales Training — Session 36

Determination Is The Ingredient.

Give Yourself 100 Days. Stay in the Game Long Enough.

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WHAT THIS SESSION IS Everyone loves confidence, success, and competence. Very few people talk about the uncomfortable period that comes before any of those things — the months where you don't know what you're doing yet, where everything is hard, where you're quietly wondering whether you're actually capable. That period is what this session is about, and how to stay in the game long enough to come out the other side.

1. The uncomfortable period everyone tries to skip

Everyone loves the finished product. Everyone loves the rep who looks effortless on a call. Everyone loves the salesperson who closes the deal in a quiet, certain voice. Very few people honestly want to talk about how that rep got there. The truth is uncomfortable. They went through months that didn't look like the finished product. The calls were awkward. The objections landed hard. The pitches drifted. Some weeks they wondered why they were still doing this.

That period is the work. Not the warm-up to the work — the work itself. The reps who reach competence aren't the ones who skipped the uncomfortable period; they're the ones who refused to walk away from it. Skipping it isn't an option that's actually on the table. The only real choice is to stay in it long enough for it to end, or to leave before the end arrives.

"Everyone loves the finished product. Almost nobody wants to talk honestly about the period before. That period is the work — not the warm-up to it."

2. Give yourself the gift of time

Most people who quit don't quit because they failed. They quit because they judged themselves too early. They decided they weren't naturally talented, decided they weren't smart enough, decided the work wasn't for them — and they made those decisions long before they'd actually given themselves a chance to prove or disprove any of it.

The corrective frame is simple but binding. Give yourself the gift of time before you decide. Not a week. Not a month. Long enough that the verdict actually has evidence behind it. Most things feel uncomfortable at the beginning — that's not failure, that's learning. Mistaking learning for failure is what produces the early exit, and the early exit is almost always the wrong call.

"Most people quit before they've given themselves a chance. They judge too early. They decide too early. They walk away before the process has had a chance to work."

3. The 100-day rule — a concrete number

"Give it time" is hard to act on without a number attached. The session offered one: 100 days. Not a day. Not a week. Not two bad afternoons. One hundred days of genuine effort before deciding whether you're capable of this work. Below that number, the verdict is premature. At 100 days, the verdict has data.

Why 100? Because at that scale, confidence stops being the starting point and becomes the result. The order most reps assume — feel confident first, then perform — is backwards. Competence comes first. Repetition comes first. Experience comes first. Confidence shows up after the other three have been doing their work for long enough. Reps who wait for confidence before performing wait forever, because confidence doesn't arrive on its own — it accumulates.

"Confidence doesn't come first. Competence comes first. Repetition comes first. Experience comes first. Confidence is usually the result. Not the starting point."

Practical move: mark day 100 in your calendar from your start date. Treat everything before that mark as data collection, not judgement. Treat the period from day 80 to day 100 as the cliff where the work starts paying back. Most reps quit between day 50 and 80 — just before the cliff. Don't be one of them.

4. Intelligence isn't the deciding factor

A common move among reps under pressure is to hide behind perceived lack of intelligence. "I'm not smart enough for this." "I'm not naturally talented like those people." "Some people just have it and I don't." Those statements feel humble. They function as exits.

The session pushed back on the frame entirely. Intelligence isn't usually what separates the reps who succeed from the reps who don't. The variable is determination — the willingness to keep going after the excitement has worn off, to keep showing up when the work becomes repetitive, to continue when progress feels slow. Plenty of intelligent people start sales careers and drift out. Less obviously gifted people who refuse to quit make the careers.

"Intelligence isn't usually the deciding factor. Determination is. The willingness to keep going after the excitement disappears."

This is genuine good news for any rep currently doubting themselves. The qualifying trait isn't something you either have or don't. It's something you choose, daily, by staying at the desk and running the process. The reps who feel "not smart enough" usually have all the intelligence they need — they just haven't yet decided to be the kind of person who refuses to walk away.

5. The pilot's licence — why the story actually matters

The session used the story of Corie getting his pilot's licence as a worked example of the determination principle. The detail worth paying attention to is what the story isn't about. It

isn't about flying. It isn't about cockpit hours. It isn't even really about pilots. The actual point is what the pursuit revealed.

Learning to fly was difficult — far harder than the seven-year-old version of the idea suggested. There were setbacks. There was an 8-month stoppage when the plane went into the workshop and the training routine collapsed entirely. There were perfectly valid moments where quitting would have been the reasonable, defensible choice. The licence didn't get earned by being naturally suited to flying. It got earned by refusing to let any of those moments be the moment.

"Difficult challenges reveal something important. Not what you know. Not how talented you are. But how determined you are when things stop being fun."

That's the point of the story. Difficulty is the test, not the obstacle. Anything that's genuinely worth doing will, at some stage, stop being fun. The rep who has practised holding the line on small commitments — showing up at day 50 with the same energy as day 5 — is the rep who holds the line on the larger commitments later. The skill is transferable, and you build it by exercising it on the small things first.

6. The "successful people are different" myth

A subtle and common assumption: that the people who appear successful are simply built differently. Smarter. More gifted. More naturally capable. Born with an advantage that other people weren't. The frame is comforting because it lets the rep off the hook — if success is about innate gifts, then the rep without those gifts isn't to blame for not achieving it.

The session offered a different explanation that's much harder to hide behind. The successful people often aren't fundamentally different. They just stayed longer. They persisted longer. They gave themselves more time. They continued after others stopped. And over time — over 5, 10, 20 years — that compounding produces an enormous visible gap that gets misattributed to talent.

"Often the difference is simpler than people think. They stayed longer. They persisted longer. They gave themselves more time. Over time, that gap becomes enormous."

This is the version of the story the rep should carry into their own career. Not "those people are different and I'm not." But "those people refused to quit, and so can I." The model is available to anyone with the discipline to use it.

7. Sales itself — same calls, different outcomes

A sobering observation about the daily reality. Some days are fantastic. Some days are frustrating. The same rep, running the same process, saying the same lines, can get wildly different outcomes from one day to the next. That isn't a bug — it's the noise inherent in the work. Treating it as a bug is what produces the spiral.

The mistake reps make is letting daily outcomes determine identity. One bad day becomes "I'm bad at this." One good day becomes "I've mastered this." Neither verdict is accurate, and both are dangerous. The bad-day verdict produces the early exit. The good-day verdict produces the complacency that ends the streak. The right move is to refuse both verdicts and keep the identity stable: "I'm a rep who runs the process consistently, regardless of what today's results happened to look like."

"One bad day doesn't mean you're bad. One good day doesn't mean you've mastered it. The focus stays on effort. Process. Consistency."

8. Effort is what you can control — the coaching contract

A specific principle restated in the session, worth holding as binding. Reps don't control every prospect. They don't control every result. They don't control every outcome. What they DO control is preparation, attitude, and whether they keep showing up. Those three things are entirely in the rep's hands.

The coaching contract follows from this. The boss looks at effort first. If effort is there and results aren't, the conversation is about process — what to adjust, how to refine, where to coach. If effort isn't there, the conversation changes. There's only one form of underperformance the agency doesn't ride out: someone who has stopped trying. Reps having a hard month don't need to fake confidence or hide bad results — they need to keep rowing. The boss is watching the oars, not the wake.

"You can't control every prospect. You can't control every result. But you can control your preparation, your attitude, and whether you keep showing up. That's where determination lives."

9. Healthy competition — push forward, not down

A culture point that came up in the session. Competition done right is one of the strongest engines a sales team has. It creates energy, accountability, and growth. It pushes individuals to improve faster than they would on their own. The reps who chase the leaderboard get better. The reps who learn to celebrate teammates' wins get better too — because watching someone close a deal demystifies what's possible.

The trap is competition done wrong. Used as a weapon — to make teammates feel smaller, to publicly humble underperformers, to create the wrong kind of fear — competition becomes corrosive instead of generative. The strongest teams compete hard AND celebrate each other in the same breath. Friendly rivalry. The bet on whose PBs get broken first. The morning joke about who got there earlier. Everything calibrated for fun, not for damage.

"Healthy competition pushes people forward. It creates energy. It creates accountability. But the purpose isn't to make people feel smaller. The purpose is to help everyone improve."

10. Culture is what people experience, not what's on the wall

Most companies talk about culture. Few actually have one. The session named the distinction. Culture isn't a poster, a values statement, or a slide deck. Culture is what happens on Wednesday afternoon when something goes wrong and people watch how it gets handled. Culture is the trust extended when there's no obvious reason to extend it. Culture is the way one colleague speaks about another when that colleague isn't in the room. Culture is the support given when nobody asks for it.

And like everything else in this session, culture compounds. Small acts repeated daily over months produce trust that's hard to articulate but obvious to anyone in the room. Small acts of disrespect repeated daily over months produce the opposite — and they're equally hard to reverse. The reps who care about the culture they're part of contribute to it actively. They aren't passengers in someone else's environment.

"Trust. Support. Communication. Opportunity. Growth. Those things aren't created through words. They're created through actions. Repeated consistently over time."

11. Stay in the game long enough

Pulling the threads together. Success is rarely about finding a secret. It's rarely about discovering something nobody else knows. There's no hidden technique that turns an average rep into a top performer in a fortnight. More often, success is about staying in the game long enough for ordinary things — repetition, practice, accumulating experience, building the wall, refining the pitch — to add up.

The reps who win aren't always the ones who started sharpest. They're often the ones who refused to leave the chair before the work paid back. Five years of consistent presence beats six months of brilliant effort, every time. The compounding curve only works for the people who stay on it long enough to see it bend.

"More often than not, success is about staying in the game long enough. Giving yourself enough time. Giving the process enough time. Refusing to quit during the period where growth feels uncomfortable."

12. Determination is the ingredient

The closing reframe of the session. Most reps, when asked what produces success, name talent or intelligence or natural ability. The session puts those names aside and offers a different one. Determination. The willingness to continue. The willingness to improve. The willingness to stay in the game long enough to become the rep you're trying to become.

This isn't a slogan. It's an operational claim. The variable that separates the reps who make careers from the reps who don't isn't gifts they were born with — it's whether they were the kind of person, day after day, week after week, who refused to give up. And that's a kind of person anyone can decide to be. It's not given. It's chosen.

"Success isn't reserved for the most gifted people. It's reserved for the people who refuse to give up before the process starts working. And that starts with giving yourself the gift of time."

13. Action items for the team

1. Mark day 100 of your tenure in your calendar. Treat everything before that mark as data collection, not verdict.
2. When you catch yourself thinking "I'm not smart enough for this," reframe to "I haven't yet decided to be the kind of person who refuses to walk away."
3. After a bad day on the phone, run the same process at the same energy on the first call of the next day. Don't change anything. The bad day was the bad day.
4. Pick one small daily commitment (a follow-up cadence, a notepad entry, a 5-minute toolbox review) and hold it without fail for 30 days. The big-commitment muscle is built on small commitments.
5. Celebrate one teammate's win out loud this week. Healthy competition compounds when both halves — competing AND celebrating — are present.
6. After a friction moment with a colleague, ask yourself which culture you're contributing to. Then contribute deliberately.
7. End each Friday by writing down the things that worked this week. Compounding is invisible week to week — the log makes it visible.

THE RULE OF THUMB Confidence doesn't come first — competence does. Give yourself 100 days. Treat difficulty as the test, not the obstacle. Effort is the only variable you fully control — and it's also the variable that compounds. Success isn't reserved for the gifted. It's reserved for the people who refuse to walk away before the work starts paying back.